

Deo, however, differs. He points out that if a full customisation is offered to the corporate or the SME customer, it has to be offered to each and every one of Orange's subscribers.

Instead, Orange offers certain bouquets of services, from which the discerning customer can choose. This makes things easier, though at the cost of complete customisability. That, however, doesn't affect the quality of service, assures Orange.

Customisation, however, is not the focus area for Reliance IndiaMobile. Instead, they focus on high-end data related services like the proprietary R-Connect Data Card and PDA-phone support. With their array of network and data services, says Sandeep M Sawant of Reliance Infocomm, they are looking at a scenario where they can provide the client with a one-stop solution for all their mobile telephony needs.

Customisation is always there, he adds, and it is in the hands of the customer.

Many Flavours To Choose From

Across all mobile service providers in the market right now, there is a huge array of feature-rich choices for the corporate customer. Apart from standard Closed User Groups, service providers offer value added services, keeping in mind the needs of a wide range of businesses.

One of these is national and global roaming. In what Hutch calls its 'single most important service for businesspeople', it has roaming tie-ups with nearly 50 national and 300 international networks giving easy access to travelling customers.

The biggest USP of Airtel's Mobile Office service is that GPRS users can use this service,

I am connected 24 hours, and at amazing speeds. Right now, I cannot imagine my existence without it

Vikram Doshi
Managing Director, ATCO Technologies

seamlessly, even while roaming in any of its 15 circles. With features such as GPRS while roaming, nationally and internationally, Airtel aims to provide subscribers with a Mobile Office while roaming in networks in USA, Canada, Hong Kong, Singapore and the Philippines.

Roaming has always been the forte for Reliance Infocomm. It provides its Mobile Office services, a part of its R-World bouquet, to roaming professionals across the country.

Tata Indicom too, provides roaming services to its mobile corporate customers.

If a client needs to make more National (STD) or International (ISD) calls, BPL Mobile helps the client migrate from a land-line based STD/ISD plan to a completely wireless package. A Fixed Cellular Terminal, or FCT, is a replacement for an ISD land-line, which is routed through the mobile network.

Mobile Sales Force Automation

A further useful feature for the corporate customer is Mobile Sales Force Automation (MSFA). To put it simply, here the mobile service aims to replace the computer with the mobile as the front-end of the ERP database.

It is designed to provide mobile sales professionals access to continuous, timely information by providing wireless access to the backend ERP system. Sales people can stay updated with the latest quotes, prices and also keep real-time track of shipments and consignments, if their ERP database supports global positioning-based tracking. MSFA is offered currently in a SMS-based format, though it can work with GPRS-enabled phones.

Or take customised SIM applications—this feature allows pre-designated users mobile access to



What The Cellular Service Providers Offer

Hutch Services:

- ☐ sms@wrk: allows managers and their team members to feed and access information to and from a central server—the most popular user group for this application being sales teams
- ☐ Group messaging allows a team member to send a single SMS to the entire team in one go
- ☐ Stock quote alerts for specific stocks—delivered via SMS
- ☐ Internet access through Hutch GPRS for those who want to log onto the Web on the go. Their services are EDGE compatible by default. EDGE or Enhanced Data rates for GSM Evolution is essentially a technology in the backend of mobile GPRS services to assure faster access and connectivity.
- ☐ Customised SIM applications—that allow pre-designated users mobile access to specific enterprise applications and databases
- ☐ MS Outlook on Hutch—that allows checking of office mails through mobile phones, over SMS or GPRS

Airtel Services

- ☐ Mobile Sales Force Automation solutions enable the company to provide timely and up-to-date information to its field force by providing wireless access to the already existing backend ERP system. The information could range from a potential lead to giving information about the availability of a particular spare part in the warehouse.
- ☐ The Airtel Corporate Directory service makes the entire list of company telephone numbers available to the employees via SMS. This list can be constantly updated from a central location. Hence there is no need for an employee to maintain and store all the relevant phone numbers on the mobile phone.
- ☐ Airtel provides simple-to-use and efficient tools for broadcasting information to customers and employees.
- ☐ General News and Business Alerts: Airtel customers can also subscribe for News and Business

News alerts to be delivered to their mobile phones via SMS.

Reliance Services

- ☐ Single mobile device for mail and office directory access. No need for Laptop or PDA.
- ☐ Enhanced productivity—faster, anytime, anywhere information access even while roaming.
- ☐ Enhanced responsiveness—for internal communication as well as external communication
- ☐ Ability to synchronise your desktop mail with your mobile mail. User friendly interface—similar to Outlook Express
- ☐ No capital expenditure on special devices
- ☐ No capital expenditure for backend enabling of mail servers
- ☐ Connects to all types of mail servers including Notes, MS Exchange, POP3 / IMAP
- ☐ Total privacy—no replication of mails at Reliance's end
- ☐ Security—supports end-to-end 128-bit encryption and SSL